

Selected DELTA Programme Design Evidence

Original source extracts supporting the Learning & Customer Education portfolio

This evidence pack contains selected extracts from original Cambridge DELTA programme-design work completed in 2013-2014. It is included as supporting evidence for the polished Learning Programme Design, ADDIE in Practice, and Action Mapping portfolio artefacts.

Portfolio note: the extracts below are presented as original source evidence rather than as a revised case study. Third-party examination pages and reproduced publisher exercises have been deliberately excluded. The focus is on original needs analysis, design decisions, objectives, and course planning.

Included evidence

- Needs analysis methodology and learner-informed findings
- Diagnostic testing, interpretation, and resulting course priorities
- Learning objectives derived from needs and diagnostic evidence
- Opening and concluding sections of the original 10-week course plan

The original programme was designed for a ten-learner FCE examination group and comprised ten two-hour lessons delivered over ten weeks. The selected evidence shows how learner data and diagnostic performance were translated into a structured learning pathway.

1. Needs analysis

Multiple evidence sources were used to identify learner needs

The original assignment documents a needs-analysis process combining a self-designed questionnaire, previous examination results, teacher input, and direct observation. It then records learner preferences for communicative practice, varied interaction, and multiple examples.

Specialist Group Needs

My learners' key needs were identified by means of a thorough self-made questionnaire (**Appendix 1**).

The questions focused on both Situation and Communicative Needs Analysis. The former refer to areas such as finding out learners' goals and motivations while the latter focuses more on the specific language needs and modalities involved (Richards, J.C. 1990). As part of the latter, I included a list of commonly tested grammatical items. In addition, I used the learners' previous end of year examination results and comments from their ex-teacher and my own personal observations to build a more complete picture of their current needs. By using these different techniques for my data gathering, I aimed to make my analysis as objective as possible. □

Original DELTA assignment extract: Specialist Group Needs

The questionnaire was completed in class by all the learners after being explained the reasoning behind it prior to starting. They were encouraged to state their true feelings and to take it seriously. I used some discussion questions as a kind of 'warmer' activity before beginning with the aim of generating interest and ideas on the way they study and think about the process. In this way, I was aiming to maximise their ability to inform me of their feelings and needs.

Overall, the main findings of the questionnaire were:

- learners identified Use of English as being the most problematic area listed from the exam skills.
- a majority stated the personal importance of improving both their grammar and speaking simultaneously, thus seeming to endorse a communicative based approach.
- a preference for a variety of interaction patterns during practice, from working alone on exam based tasks to pair, group and whole class work.
- being exposed to plenty of examples in different ways also proved popular thus emphasising the wish for variety in course practice.

See **Appendix 2** for the Needs Analysis summary.

Original DELTA assignment extract: questionnaire findings

2. Diagnostic evidence to course priorities

Assessment findings were converted into explicit design priorities

The assignment records the use of a diagnostic test, analyses stronger and weaker task performance, and then turns those findings into specific course priorities. The design response includes strategy training, staged task deconstruction, language-form work, and a communicative approach.

Diagnostic Testing and Results

I decided that the most logical and appropriate Diagnostic Test to use would be a practice FCE Use of English Test (Harrison, M. 2008 **Appendix 3**), thus ensuring high validity, reliability and practicality. Face validity is important here as the learners can see they are being tested on exactly what is supposed to be tested and that the scoring will be objective (Harmer, J. 2007). Reliability is also present as the learners have already been exposed to the test formats and instructions and are also familiar with the timing and scoring system. Furthermore, the test was designed by the University of Cambridge English Assessment department which has worldwide recognition and prestige. The multiple-choice and gap fill test tasks make it highly practical in terms of a fixed marking key and might explain the popularity of such tests (Thornbury, S. 2006).

This test consists of four fixed sections of various 'indirect' test-item types which consist of multiple choice, open cloze gap fills, word formation and sentence transformation tasks. A range of grammatical, lexical and discourse features are tested throughout the test.

As can be seen from the summary analysis of results (**Appendix 4**), the learners did better overall on the Part 1 Multiple-choice task with an average 61%, enough for a pass at FCE level. However, the other parts caused more problems in general with averages of just 38-39% here. I feel the multiple choice task offers

Original DELTA assignment extract: diagnostic testing and results

are on offer, learners stumbled with incomplete transformations, often leaving out essential detail in their rewritten sentences such as names and pronouns possibly indicating some uncertainty with task understanding and technique.

Course Priorities

With an average test class mark of 43.6%, it is clear that the learners need to be presented with an intensive but motivating course on Use of English skills and practice. I feel improving concentration is a key factor in improving the students' scores when it comes to examination practice as forgetting key instructions and techniques seems to lead to some careless errors. Priority on exploring different word forms and how they grammatically link and fit around other language in longer text types will be beneficial in improving the learners' performances, especially in Parts 2 and 3.

Deconstructing the examination tasks into separate individual stages and rebuilding them will I feel be both motivating and useful for both the more visual and kinaesthetic type learners in the group and a useful approach to practicing skills and strategies for all parts of the test. A communicative slant must be incorporated so that the relatively young learners do not feel they will be doing purely 20 hours of written grammar practice but acquiring speaking practice and fluency at the same time as well as keeping them active and interested after a day studying at school

Original DELTA assignment extract: course priorities and programme transition

3. Learning objectives

Needs and diagnostic data were translated into measurable course direction

The original objectives show two linked strands: learner training in examination strategies and language input/practice. The objectives connect task understanding, contextual recognition, prediction, staged problem-solving, grammar and lexical development, and interactive practice.

between them.

Based on my background reading and study of my learners' Needs Analysis and Diagnostic testing data, I have established the following **key objectives** for my course.

Learner Training

1. Raise the learners' awareness of and proficiency in using key examination strategies for the Use of English examination paper by:

- A) Full understanding of exam format, rubrics and marking
- B) Understanding the importance of recognising language in context from input texts
- C) Encouraging prediction and logical discrimination with exam tasks
- D) Breaking exam tasks down into clear logical stages

Language Input/Practice

2. Improve their knowledge of tenses, verb forms and other commonly tested grammatical and lexical forms in the context of the examination tasks by:

- A) Revising key tense forms/phrasal verbs and common verb/noun collocations
- B) Recognising correct parts of speech and word forms (adverbs/adjectives/nouns) within the exam format and practice activities
- C) Revising key prepositional forms and collocations within the examination format
- D) Using real past examination and practice tasks to compliment language and learner training input
- E) By using motivational and interactive exam-based communicative activities

Syllabus and Course Content

Original DELTA assignment extract: key objectives and syllabus transition

4. Ten-week pathway: opening

Lesson 1 establishes diagnosis, strategy awareness, and initial practice

The original course-plan table maps each lesson to course objectives and records lesson staging, practice, feedback, materials, and homework. Colour coding distinguished learner training, language input, examination practice/feedback, and communicative practice.

Original 10-week course plan, opening page

FCE Use of English Course Plan
10 two hour lessons over 10 weeks from 6th February 2014 to 10th April 2014
Key: **Learner Training**, **Grammar/Lexical Input**, **Examination Practice/Feedback**, **Communicative Language Practice**

Lesson Number and Date	Reference to Course Objective	Lesson Content (staging, focus, practice, feedback)	Materials with references	Homework Set
Lesson 1 6/02/14	1A	Warmer Discussion -learners' thoughts and feelings on the Use of English test (linking back to Diagnostic Test results) Use of English Quiz/Discussion Questions – format/rubrics/answer sheet/marking scheme and general regulations	Self-made materials (Appendix 1)	
	1A/2D	Parts 1 and 2 Test Practice -diagnosing rubric and answer sheet issues/introduction to key test strategies/initial test practice and feedback		
	1B/1C/1D	Learner Training -elicitation and discussion of key concepts in Parts 1/2 (prediction from context/text types/logical discrimination)		
	2E	Part 1 Practice Activity-Mixed Up Story (multiple-choice cloze-answer discrimination and story ordering)	Wyatt, R. (2002, pg94) First Certificate Games and Activities (Appendix 2)	
				Kenny,N/,Luque-Mortimer,L.(pg14) FCE Practice Tests Plus 2 Use of English: Format and Guidance

5. Ten-week pathway: conclusion

The final lessons move from integrated practice to reflection and next-step planning

The concluding plan shows the progression towards a full practice test, structured feedback, learner-led reflection, and preparation planning. This provides source evidence for the programme-level sequencing and evaluation described in the portfolio artefacts.

Lesson 10 10/04/14	2D 1A/1B/1C/1D	Warmer-learner led discussion on the FCE Use of English Test- compare thoughts now with beginning of the course-what's changed? Practice Test Feedback-review section by section/pairs/class/common problems/tips and result feedback FCE Use of English – DOs and DON'Ts Learner Preparation DOs and DON'Ts-learners write and then discuss in pairs good (or bad) ways to prepare in the following 2 months for the FCE Use of English Test.	Self-made materials plus from FCE Examination Report June '09 (Appendix 12) Student generated materials	
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Original 10-week course plan, final page

This pack is intentionally selective. The full DELTA submission contains additional academic discussion and appendices, but those materials are not required to substantiate the portfolio claims shown here.